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Lingua inglese

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NOUNS

1. Singular and plural nouns

2. Countable and uncountable nouns

3. Expressing quantity

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Singular and plural nouns

singular	**plural**
table	table**s**
chair	chair**s**
window	window**s**

Most nouns take **–s** in plural. Nouns ending in *-ch, -sh, -s, -x* get ***-es.***

bus	bus**es**
watch	watch**es**
match	match**es**

Singular and plural nouns

- Spelling:

Nouns ending in a consonant + -y, take away the -y and add **-ies**.

family	famil**ies**
city	cit**ies**

Nouns ending in a vowel + -y, just add an -s.

boy	boy**s**
tray	tray**s**

Singular and plural nouns

There are nouns that do not follow the rules. They have an irregular plural form:

man	men
woman	women
child	children
tooth	teeth
foot	feet
mouse	mice
sheep	sheep
fish	fish
shelf	shelves
wife	wives
knife	knives

Countable and uncountable nouns

Nouns in English have two big groups:

- countable nouns [C], which have **singular and plural forms** and

- uncountable nouns [U], which have **only singular forms**.

Study the following list which contains some important uncountable nouns:

water	milk	juice	information	baggage	luggage
news	furniture	advice	equipment	weather	money
knowledge	travel	progress	luck	work	

Countable and uncountable nouns

Rules to remember:

a) *A/an* (indefinite article) can only be used with singular nouns → e.g. *a car, a baby, a flat, a garden*

b) there are some countable nouns which have irregular plural forms, so they do not have -s plural, but they are still countable → e.g. *people, children, men, women*

c) materials are uncountable → e.g. *plastic, metal, wood*

d) some uncountable nouns have a different meaning with *some* → e.g. *a glass* (for drinking), ***some*** *glass* (material), *a tea* (a cup of tea), ***some*** *tea* (the material)

e) some nouns have a plural meaning though they have a singular form → e.g. *police*

f) some nouns are always plural → e.g. *sunglasses, shorts, trousers*

g) some nouns are always singular and uncountable → e.g. *information, furniture, advice, news* (even if there is an –s ending)

Expressing quantity

We may use different words to express quantity with countable and uncountable nouns.

words that go with **[C] (countable) + plural**	**words that go with** **[U] (uncountable) + singular**
many / How many?	much / How much?
a lot of	a lot of
lots of	lots of
few	little
a few	a little
some, any, no	some, any, no
enough	enough
plenty of	plenty of
How many?	How much?

Expressing quantity

[C] (countable) + plural	[U] (uncountable) + singular
How many apples are there for the cake?	**How much** milk do you need for the cake?
How many foreigners did you see in there?	**How much** progress have you made?
How many gold coins did they find in the cave?	**How much** gold did they find in the cave?
A lot of football fans travel abroad with the team.	**A lot of** information was provided by the project manager.
Lots of football fans travel abroad with the team.	**Lots of** information was provided by the project manager.
	There is **little** water in the glass. Please bring some more.
There are **few** people in the street because it's raining.	There is **a little** in my purse. Let's go to the cinema.
A few people passed the test but not many.	
	There is **some** water in the glass.
	There is not **any** cheese in the fridge.
There are **some** book**s** on the shelf.	There was **no** milk left.
There are not **any** onion**s** at home.	
There were **no** people around.	There isn't **enough** flour for the pancake.
	There is **plenty of** room for you here.
There aren't **enough** egg**s** for the omelette.	
Plenty of people went to see the arrival of the Queen.	

Expressing quantity

Some and any

In general, we use ***some*** in positive sentences and ***any*** in negative sentences.

We bought **some** books.

We didn't buy **any** books.

We can use ***any*** in positive sentences with a negative meaning.

She left without **any** money. (she **didn't take any** money with her)

Expressing quantity

We use both ***some*** and ***any*** in questions. In most questions, we use ***any*;** however, we use ***some*** when we offer or ask for things.

Can I have **some** water, please?

Would you like **some** coffee?

We can count quantities of some uncountable things with *cup, litre, pint, packet, piece* etc.

There are two litres of mineral water in the fridge.

A pint of beer, please.

Could you get three cartons of milk from the shop?

This is a really nice piece of furniture.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR ATTENTION!

NOUNS

Task 1

Choose the correct alternative.

1) How *many* / *much* money have we got?
2) How *many* / *much* children are there in the park?
3) I haven't got *much* / *many* time.
4) Could you give me *a* / *some* glass of water?
5) The information *was* / *were* incorrect.
6) The news *start* / *starts* at 8 o'clock.
7) We need *a lot of* / *many* new furniture.
8) Could you give me *some* / *lot of* orange juice, please?
9) I want to have *an* / -- advice on which book I should read.
10) The show was so boring that only *little* / *few* people stayed until the end.

Task 2

Fill in the gaps with *a, an, some* or --.

I have always wanted to be (1)_____ Olympic athlete.

(2)_____ of the events I visited last year were extraordinary.

Do you enjoy going to (3)_____ open-air concerts?

The ballet performance I saw (4)_____ days ago was (5)_____ unusual one.

The dancers were wearing (6)_____ trousers and gloves.

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Would you like (7)_____ advice on how to book a festival ticket as quickly as possible?

What (8)_____ terrible weather! It's spoilt the whole show.

Mary had two big suitcases and (9)_____ hand luggage.

What (10)_____ wonderful performers!

Would you like (11)_____ wine with the meal?

What (12)_____ exciting show!

Task 3

Fill in the gaps using *little / a little / few / a few*.

1) Can I ask you _____ questions?

2) I have _____ time for my hobbies.

3) "How much coffee would you like ?" "Just _____ ."

4) Peter has a peaceful life. He has _____ problems.

5) "How long did you stay there?" "Only _____ months."

6) "Can you speak Hungarian?" "Just _____ ."

7) Can you lend me _____ Euros?

8) Before exams I'm always _____ bit nervous.

9) They don't like him. He has _____ friends.

10) There was _____ traffic, so we weren't late.

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KEY

Task 1

1) much 2) many 3) much 4) a 5) was 6) starts 7) a lot of 8) some 9) -- 10) few

Task 2

1) an 2) Some 3) -- 4) some 5) an 6) --
7) -- / some 8) --9) some / -- 10) -- 11) some / -- 12) an

Task 3

1) a few 2) little 3) a little 4) few 5) a few 6) a little 7) a few 8) a little 9) few 10) little

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NOUNS

Task

Choose the correct alternative A), B) or C).

1) We've got _____ to buy a new dress for the wedding.
A) any money B) some monies C) lots of money

2) How _____ attended the concert?
A) many people B) much person C) few audience

3) There is _____ break between the two acts of the performance.
A) a little B) a few C) many

4) I need _____ about the running event.
A) an information B) informations C) some information

5) Because of the downpour _____ got soaked to the skin at the open-air concert.
A) lot of people B) a lots of people C) plenty of people

6) The show was a great success although _____ money was spent on producing it.
A) a little B) little C) much

7) Have you got _____ tickets left for the evening show by any chance?
A) any B) much C) little

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8) Oh, your glass is empty. Would you like _____ more wine?
A) any B) much C) some

9) I don't like listening to the news. _____ full of accidents, failures and wars.
A) These are B) It is C) They are

10) As there weren't _____, the musicians cancelled the concert.
A) enough spectator B) enough spectators C) spectators enough

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KEY

1) C (lots of money)
2) A (many people)
3) A (a little)
4) C (some information)
5) C (plenty of people)
6) B (little)
7) A (any)
8) C (some)
9) B (It is)
10) B (enough spectators)

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